



Chinmaya Sakshi

**E-Newsletter of
Chinmaya International Residential School**

E-Newsletter

The Ex-Cultural and Literary Team Speaks...

July-Sept 2008

Hari om,

As all good things come to an end, so did our term as the Editorial Committee. The year was full of surprises for us. The starting of the “E-Newsletter” and the first ever school magazine, “CHINMAYAM AWARENESS” was all done with the help of our School Management. With their help and support we got the opportunity to lead the Literary team.

With this opportunity given to us, we would like to express our heartfelt gratitude to a few people without whom the E-Newsletter wouldn't have been possible. We would like to thank our Principal, Anurag Sir for his constant support, Sunanda Ma'am for always being there for us, Ravi Kumar Sir for helping us even at the last moment. Chinmaya Sakshi would have been incomplete without their help and support.

Also we would like to thank our readers for their constant support and their advices which only helped us to become better. As our term ends, we would only request you to continue your support and care which you showered on us and welcome the new editorial team for the year 2008-2009 led by Varun Bharadwaj and Prarthana Lohia.

We would like to end our year with one last note: “Thank you for everything!!”

Shruti Kedia,
Viswanth
Savi Kerkar
Literary and Cultural
Secretaries



From The Editors' Desk

Hari Om!

A new responsibility has dawned on us. We are now faced with the expectations to deliver the events which occur in this school as creatively as our predecessors. We realize that, being in a residential school, it is our duty as Literary and Cultural Secretaries to bridge the gap between the parents and the school events. The new task at hand has taught us many valuable skills and the difficulty which goes behind the producing of a newsletter. We learned to put our minds together and by working together as a team and keeping a firm goal in mind we were able to deliver to the readers what our predecessors called a "high valued end product".

This being our first newsletter, we have put in our best effort, but we promise you improvement with every successive publication. We hope to receive the same support as the previous team by receiving any feedback or comments you would like to give. As a wise man once said "A seed can only become a tree, with the support of air, water and nutrients, but with any of these elements missing, the tree will never be." Together we can make this form of communication between the school and the parents stronger and impervious. We are looking forward to the coming year with enthusiasm.

Thank You!

Varun Bharadwaj, Prarthana Lohia : Senior Literary and Cultural Secretaries
Manish Punjabi, Meghna Nambiar: Junior Literary and Cultural Secretaries



New Students Council

“It is said that with great power comes great responsibility.”

On 3rd August, the Students Council for the year 2007-2008 passed on the baton to the incoming council with a hope of a better and a progressive tomorrow.

The new incoming Student Council was led by Anirudh Belle and Stuti Khemka, our School Deans.

The new term for the Student Council started with a morning puja followed by the solemn occasion of Investiture Ceremony where they were handed over the responsibility of the school. They took an oath where they swore to honestly and impartially carry out their duties. They were handed their badges by Anurag Sir and Jaya Ma'am. Accepting this was like accepting the responsibility of the whole school.

The new council has started their work with a new spark, full of bright ideas and a new outlook.



New Students Council

SCHOOL DEANS		SPORTS SECRETARIES	
Boy: Anirudh Belle		Senior Boy: Dhiaan S S	
Girl: Stuti Khemka		Senior Girl: Neha Agarwalla	
		Junior Boy: Vasudev Parakkot	
		Junior Girl: Narmada Udayakumar	
LITERARY AND CULTURAL SECRETARIES			
Senior Boy: Varun Bharadwaj		Junior Boy: Manish Punjabi	
Senior Girl: Prarthana Lohia		Junior Girl: Meghna Nambiar	
HOUSE CAPTAINS			
House	Senior Captains		Junior Captains
Vyasa	Vinit Vekaria Manveenaa Bhasker		Nikhil Sharma Shwetha Ramji
Viswamithra	Swapnam Kajaria Lipi Mehta		Srijan Chugh Rhea Krishna
Valmiki	Anurag Saboo S. Nanthitha		Arjun Jhaveri Indhu Solayappan
Vashistha	Sudharshan R C Nikita Shan Kumar		Akash Ghai Sakhi Todi



English Week

English, one of the most widely spoken languages in the world, has a vast number of different aspects which were tested during the English Quiz. The English Department conducted the quiz and created a variety of different rounds accompanied by a presentation. The first round was named the Author and Poet Round in which clues were given to each house about the author and poet and the team had to guess the name before the entire picture was revealed. This round was followed by the “Wuzzle” Round, which consisted of a series of word puzzles that would be displayed in a unique manner, the team would then guess what the phrase was. For example:

Dr.Doolittle

This can be translated to Dr. Doolittle. The round that followed was the Jumbled Words Round in which the participants were given jumbled words and they had to solve them within 45 seconds. This round was followed by the “Dumb Charades” round. In this round one member of each team was given a phrase that they would have to act out without speaking or making any sounds. This was by far the most entertaining round as the students were able to watch their fellow peers attempting to enact their phrase in the oddest manner. After this came the final round which was the Rapid Fire round. At the end, the standings

Guru Poornima

A “Guru” is one who imparts his knowledge to the world. He guides and moulds his disciples like a potter gives shape to clay. Guru Poornima is celebrated on the birthday of the Param Guru, Rishi Veda Vyasa. On this day we recognize the great lineage of the Gurus which began with Rishi Veda Vyasa followed by Shri Adishankaracharya after whom came Swami Tapovanam Maharaj who was the Guru of our Param Pujya Swami Chinmayananda who is followed by our dear Gururji- Swami Tejomayananda.

Our day began with a pooja which was conducted by the old Students Council. At the end of the pooja all the students sought blessings of all their “Gurus”- their teachers. In the evening there was a special aarti, conducted by the Music Department which involved the contribution of teachers as well as students. It was really a spectacular aarti as the decorations of the Multi Purpose Hall added to the lively ambience. This day will always be remembered by all of us as on this day we realized the greatness and speciality of our Gurus.

Mathematics Week

The term Mathematics may sound boring for some but after the Mathematics Week conducted in CIRS from 21st to the 26th of July, the term Mathematics was no longer boring.

It comprised of presentations done by our professional teachers, a Vox Populi, in which our students put their full effort in convincing everyone of whether Maths is a Science or an Art, a Maths Walk where we got to discover the magic and mysteries which Maths had hidden for us, and finally, field trips in which we got to take down energy consumption of our teachers' residences followed by measuring activities.



Language Quiz

Language is a medium which is used to communicate. And as we all know, CIRS encourages many languages so that each of our students becomes a globalized citizen. In our school we have an option of learning 3 languages besides English. They are Sanskrit, Hindi, and French. Thus a Language Quiz was conducted in CIRS on the 23rd of July. It was based on the three Languages which our school offers- French, Hindi and Sanskrit.

The French and Sanskrit quiz was won by the Viswamitra House while the Hindi quiz was won by the Valmiki House. This quiz took our students to the depth of these three languages. This quiz was the first of its kind as it was conducted by the students themselves. This occasion was graced by Pujya Swami Swaroopanandaji.

Gurudev Maha Samadhi Day

Swami Chinmayananda was a great Guru who inspired the lives of many and touched millions of hearts. It was on the 3rd of August that he left us physically and joined the infinite. Thus we celebrate this day in CIRS with great enthusiasm.

We began the day by invoking Gurudev's blessings with a pooja which was followed by the sacred Investiture Ceremony where the outgoing council, after a year's hard work handed over their posts to the new council 2008-09.

After this, all the students participated in various class activities which were a true example of "fun with learning". The activities enabled us to know more about the greatness of our Guru.

The celebrations of this day ended with a special aarti which was organized by the Music Department.



Science Week

The Science Week was conducted by the Science Department and consisted of various activities for students that would enhance their interest in Science. The Week began with a presentation given by Venkat Sir, IB co-ordinator and Physics teacher, about what role Physics plays in movies. He showed various movie clippings in which the laws of Physics were followed and others in which they were clearly ignored.

The 11th IB and CBSE Science students went to the Shakti Sugars Soya Division where the students saw how various soya products were made from the soya plant. The 12th IB and CBSE Science students went to Ooty where they had the opportunity to see and observe how a radio telescope functioned.

Management Week

The Management Week started off with a wonderful quiz on Marketing by the 11th CBSE Management students. The quiz was based on logos, advertisements and other things such as punchlines which make marketing possible.

The next day followed with an interview which the students of 12th CBSE Management conducted with the “Management Guru”, Swami Swaroopanandaji himself. It was truly a learning experience for everyone. Apart from the Management students, the other students too could relate to and try to implement his ideas.

The IB 1st year students had a presentation on Business Management which was beautifully presented.

Also, the IB 2nd year students along with the 12th CBSE Management students were taken on a field trip to Mr. Light, a showroom for lampshades, as a part of the Management Week celebrations.

Independence Day

A struggle for freedom which lasted for more than 200 years, in which millions of people gave up their life, for the day of independence and after a long period we finally achieved it on the 15th of August in 1947.

Every year we proudly celebrate this day to commemorate India's independence from the British rule and its birth as a Sovereign Nation. This year in our school we began this day by hoisting 62 Indian flags depicting 62 years of independence by the Council members, Class Representatives and Head of Departments of our school. Then with the support of the Creativity Activity Service (CAS) programme the school invited tribal children to show their talent by singing patriotic songs in English and dancing.

Thereafter the juniors had a flag pooja, in which they worshipped the Indian flag. Some students spoke about the pride of India and its status and possession in the world to their classmates. Then there was an extravagant exhibition "India Shining" where we had a glimpse on India and its greatness. After that there was a quiz on India where general knowledge questions on India were asked. Then in the Audio Visual room there was a presentation of great people talking about India followed by many patriotic movie clips. There was also a patriotic skit presented by some students.

Overall the day was very enriching and we got to know more about India's greatness. Hence leaving a feeling of patriotism and pride for our mother land and the people who sacrificed their lives for this day 62 years ago.

JAI HIND!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!



Raksha Bandhan

How do we define a relationship between a brother and a sister? How powerful is the sister's love for the brother? Though the sister and brother fight like Tom and Jerry during controversial times or times of trouble they are there supporting and correcting each other. It is really a very unique relationship.

The day began with the auspicious Upanayanam Ceremony followed by Raksha Bandhan celebrations. This bond between the brother and the sisters of CIRS was celebrated on the 16th of August. This day was celebrated by the girls or better called “sisters” tying rakhi's to their brothers and also by giving chocolates and sweets to each other. To enrich the ambience of that day, the day before Raksha Bhandan, class wise the boys of every grade conducted a program “brotherhood” for their adorable sisters. Some by imitating the girls, and some by having fun with them. Towards the tail end of the day there was a wonderful skit by Br. Rishi bhaiya and our dear Darshini didi which reminded us of the memorable moments with our siblings. It was really a touching skit, specially for those student whose siblings were not with them during the celebrations.

Overall the day was very special as it strengthened the relation between the brothers and sisters of CIRS, and we learnt the value of mutual protection, be external or emotional protection. We the brothers and sisters of CIRS are always there to help each other!



Sri Krishna Janmashtami

The day was full of various festivities pertaining to the birth of Lord Krishna. The main event was an evening program revolving around the 9 forms of worship and how it was applied in various stories. The students put on a marvelous spectacle, with each class performing various stories. The program ended just before midnight and Swami Swaroopananda then addressed the audience, describing Krishna's birth.

At exactly midnight we all welcomed the Lord's birth by singing bhajans and even getting to rock the cradle in which a "symbolic baby Krishna" slept. This was followed by the ever famous ritual of "Matka Phod". The boys and girls of all the classes were given various locations in which a pot hung in the air. Annas on the roofs would pull the pots higher as students reached them. In the end every class was successful at breaking their pot and eating the goodies inside. The experience was unforgettable.



Paryushan

Paryushan is a seven day fast, observed to keep alive the principles of Lord Mahavira. This is basically a “Jain” festival, but many other students were very enthusiastic and willing to follow this ritual. For these seven days, all students, who by choice, observed this fast by eating food which was different from the food that the others normally ate.

All these days, the students who opted to observe the fast didn't eat any roots or green vegetables. It is in this period that the farms are more vulnerable to the pests and insects, and so this is the reason we avoid eating roots and green vegetables to keep our mind, body, and soul pure.

On the last day of this festival of Paryushan, we wished each other “*Michhami Dukkham*” as a way of asking for forgiveness for whatever sins we have committed and in whatever way we have hurt someone's feeling.

Social Science Week

The past is history and yet we are here today learning about what we, our ancestors did. You might wonder why we learn about the world war or the history of the Great Wall of China while all these incidents are all over a long time ago but what we do not realize is that when we learn history we realize the mistakes our ancestors did and we learn from it. When we learn the world map and know the location of all the wonders of the world we know where we want to go next vacations. But we are not to blame if we sometimes get bored of this subject.

Our school has kept up the spirit of this unique subject in the most unique of ways. After the junior school enjoyed a little sightseeing during their visit to the museum they learnt about twenty six new and interesting places starting with “A” all the way to “Z”. Then they got an opportunity to express their views in the class debate which was held on the 3rd of September.

We then saw a presentation by Diwakar Sir (Head of Social Science Department) through which we got to know how interesting this subject can really be. But at the end of the day even this event did not go untested. The Social Science Quiz was held in which we got to know where we stand. No points were given as this quiz was meant for our knowledge alone. We all enjoyed and learnt together and now we all see this boring subject from a “not so boring” point of view.

Sri Ganesh Chaturthi

Ganesh Chaturthi was celebrated with great pomp and show for ten days with joy and devotion towards the bulky lord- lord Ganesha. The beautiful rangolis made by the respective classes everyday were simply captivating to see. They depicted the lord in various patterns. The poojas in the morning and the bhajans in the evening were fantastic. Everyone was involved.

The visarjan took place at the end with a blast of music and crackers and all enjoyed dancing on the way. It was just the right way of bidding farewell to the idol of the lord and not the lord since he lives in our hearts always!

Teachers Day

Teachers day was a day in which students displayed their appreciation towards their teachers in various ways. The first event of the day was a 'mock assembly' in which students impersonated teachers and acted out any unique traits or sayings that teacher had. The students went to the extent of dressing just like their teacher and even mimicking their voice. This was followed by a set of unique games for teachers such as face painting and even musical chairs. The day ended with a special program, in which the students awarded prizes to some of the teachers and conduct insightful interviews of teachers.



Onam

The great welcoming of the King Mahabali took place on 12 September, celebrated in the form of Onam. Our school had made a rangoli with flower petals for the great and generous king who is allowed to come to the face of this planet for these ten days every year to be with his people and be a part of this festivity. We enjoyed a special lunch wearing our traditional clothes.

Creativity Action Service

In today's world we can see that there is just enough for everyone's need not for everyone's greed. Those who are reading this article must know that we are the fortunate ones who live on the island of plenty but unfortunately there are those who are drowning in the ocean of depravity. IB believes in all holistic development of an individual which includes the sentimental feelings towards others. We are taught through our course to help these people. We, the CAS students of the IB 1st year have worked out a program to help a nearby tribal school, Sadivayal, and their students. We have decided to make their stay happier and more fruitful. We have also decided to educate them instead of giving them something- if a man is taught how to catch fish, he will never starve. We have done this in a variety of ways including teaching of Basic English and patriotic songs including the National Anthem. They showed our school their appreciation by performing a skit on Independence Day. We have had a great learning experience and a wonderful time interacting with all the children. The joy of elevating someone in life is limitless

Half Yearly Examination

Examinations are very important as they test what the students have learnt in the entire term. The Half Yearly Examinations in CIRS took place in the 2nd and 3rd week of September. The examination mood was on in full swing and students put in their best. It was a crucial time for all students as they went to the extent of sacrificing their precious sleep, games and leisure time to do well in their examinations.

Results were out by the 20th of September making many happy and disappointing others.